

Feature	fwbackups	Bacula	Amanda	BackupPC	Lucky Backup
Licence	GNU GPLv2	Affero GNU GPLv3	BSD License	GNU GPLv2	GNU GPLv3
Multi-platform	Linux, Windows and Mac OS X	Linux, Windows, Mac OS X	Linux and Windows	Linux and Windows	Windows, Linux and Mac OS X
Backup levels	Full, incremental	Full, differential, Incremental, consolidation	Full, incremental	Full, incremental	Full, incremental
Data format	Compressed archive, open	Custom, fully open	Open, recoverable without Amanda	tar over ssh is used to back up data	Custom, fully open
GUI	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Table 1: Comparing fwbackups with other software

the left side. It generates a new window where we have to specify the path, destination, time and date of backups. The path tab allows you to select files or folders which have to be included in the backup set. Files or folders can be added using the *Add Files* or *Add Folder* button, respectively. A red icon next to the path indicates that the path cannot be read or is missing, whereas a green icon shows fwbackups is able to read the path. Files can also be included by dragging and dropping them onto the path list (see Figure 2).

2. Setting the destination

The destination tab allows you to decide where the backup file is to be saved. Backup files can be saved to a local drive, removable storage or a remote computer using *Open SSH* server. There is also an option to test settings for the SFTP protocol which ensures that the remote host is accessible to fwbackups and backup can be done without any interruption see Figure 3.

3. Setting the time

The time tab allows the user to control the time and date in which the backup is done. There are two options to do this—you can choose between easy configuration or manual configuration. The easy configuration uses drop-down boxes and sliders to determine the time and date which eases the operation. fwbackups runs the backup operation whenever the date matches the chosen parameters see Figure 4.

4. Changing the backup file format

On the *Options* tab, you may find a lot of useful features. The format of the backup file can be changed to archive (tar), compressed archive (tar.gz) and direct copy. Choosing different file formats affects the size of the files, since they can be reduced by compressing the files.

How fwbackups compares with other backup software

Even though there are a lot of backup software available in the market now, it is fwbackups simple and powerful interface that distinguishes it from other open source backup software. The strategy to focus on ease of use keeps fwbackups a step ahead of other open source backup software see Table 1.

What's new in fwbackups 1.43.4

Fwbackups 1.43.4 has come with several bug fixes which

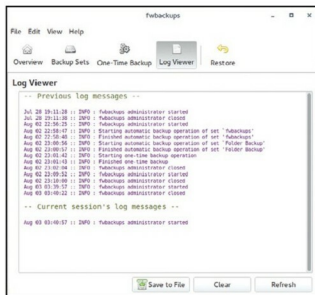


Figure 6: Log viewer

were reported in the previous versions. It has several improvements including:

- Issues that prevented backups from executing correctly have been fixed
- Backups are now cleaned and re-scheduled automatically
- Better handling paths with special characters
- The problem of files sometimes getting excluded from backups if the compressed archive backend was used, has been fixed

References

- <http://www.diffingo.com/oss/fwbackups>
- <http://bacula.org/>
- <http://www.amanda.org/>
- <http://backuppc.sourceforge.net/info.html#screenShots>
- <http://www.diffingo.com/oss/fwbackups/features>
- <http://www.diffingo.com/downloads/fwbackups/docs/html/>

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